
CONSTITUTION AND BYLAWS OF TRI-CITY ASSEMBLY OF GOD

January 21, 1996

TABLE OF CONTENTS

TABLE OF CONTENTS	ii
REVISION HISTORY	iv
PREAMBLE	1
CONSTITUTION	1
ARTICLE I. NAME	1
ARTICLE II. PREROGATIVES	1
Section 1. Self Government.	1
Section 2. Real Estate.	1
ARTICLE III. AFFILIATION AND RELATIONSHIP	1
ARTICLE IV. TENETS OF FAITH	2
STATEMENT OF FUNDAMENTAL TRUTHS:	2
1. The Scriptures Inspired:	2
2. The One True God:	2
3. The Deity of the Lord Jesus Christ:	3
4. The Fall of Man:	3
5. The Salvation of Man:	3
6. The Ordinances of the Church:	3
7. The Baptism in the Holy Ghost:	4
8. The Evidence of the Baptism in the Holy Ghost:	4
9. Sanctification:	4
10. The Church and it's Mission:	4
11. The Ministry:	5
12. Divine Healing:	5
13. The Blessed Hope:	5
14. The Millennial Reign of Christ:	5
15. The Final Judgment:	5
16. The New Heavens and the New Earth:	6
ARTICLE V. ORDINANCES	6
Section 1. Water Baptism.	6
Section 2. The Lord's Supper.	6
ARTICLE VI. MEMBERSHIP	6
Section 1. Membership Eligibility.	6
Section 2. Junior Membership	6
Section 3. Inactive Membership.	6
ARTICLE VII. OFFICERS	7
Section 1. Officers.	7
Section 2. Deacons and Trustees.	7
ARTICLE VIII. MEETINGS	7
Section 1. Public Worship.	7
Section 2. Annual Business Meetings.	7
Section 3. Special Business Meetings.	8
Section 4. Quorum.	8
Section 5. Board of Administration Meetings.	8
Section 6. The Board of Deacons Meetings.	8
ARTICLE IX. DEPARTMENTS AND COMMITTEES	8
Section 1. Sunday School.	8
Section 2. Youth Ministries.	8

Section 3. Men's and Women's Ministries.	8
Section 4. Other Departments.	9
Section 5. Relationship.	9
ARTICLE X. FINANCES	9
ARTICLE XI. PROPERTY	9
Section 1. Deed.	9
Section 2. Defection.	9
Section 3. Cessation.	10
ARTICLE XII. AMENDMENTS	10
BYLAWS	11
ARTICLE I. DUTIES OF OFFICERS	11
Section 1. Pastor.	11
Section 2. Board of Deacons.	11
Section 3. Board of Administration.	11
Section 4. Secretary.	12
Section 5. Treasurer.	12
Section 6. Assistant Treasurer.	12
ARTICLE II. ELECTIONS AND VACANCIES	12
Section 1. Pastor.	12
Section 2. Treasurer and Assistant Treasurer.	12
Section 3. Deacons and Trustees.	13
Section 4. Secretary.	13
Section 5. Vacancies.	13
Section 6. The Nominating Committee.	14
ARTICLE III. MEMBERSHIP	14
Section 1. Requirements.	14
Section 2. Reception of Members.	15
Section 3. Discipline.	15
Section 4. Voluntary Withdraw.	15
Section 5. Membership Roll Revision.	15
ARTICLE IV. SUNDAY SCHOOL	15
ARTICLE V. YOUTH DEPARTMENT	16
ARTICLE VI. PROPERTY RIGHTS	16
Section 1. Holding.	16
Section 2. Transferring.	16
Section 3. Certification.	16
ARTICLE VII. ORDER OF BUSINESS	16
ARTICLE VIII. PARLIAMENTARY ORDER	16
ARTICLE IX. AMENDMENTS	16

REVISION HISTORY

- 09/19/82: Adopted
- 04/14/85: Amended Constitution, Article VII, Section 1.
Amended Constitution, Article X.
Appended to Bylaws, Article I, Section 5.
Amended Bylaws, Article II, Section 2.
- 01/31/88: Amended Bylaws, Article II, Section 2.
Appended to Bylaws, Article II, Section 2.
- 01/14/90: Amended Constitution, Article VII, Section 1.
Amended Constitution, Article VII, Section 2.
Amended Constitution, Article VIII, Section 3.
Amended Constitution, Article VIII, Section 5.
Appended to Constitution, Article VIII (added Section 6).
Amended Constitution, Article IX, Section 2.
Amended Constitution, Article IX, Section 3.
Amended Constitution, Article X.
Amended Bylaws, Article I.
Amended Bylaws, Article II, Section 3.
Amended Bylaws, Article II, Section 4.
Amended Bylaws, Article II, Section 5, Subsection B, Paragraph (a).
Amended Bylaws, Article V.
- 01/22/95: Amended Bylaws, Article I, Section 4.
Amended Bylaws, Article II, Section 2.
- 1/21/96: Readopted. Reformatted document to incorporate all amendments, add a table of contents with uniform indexing, and correct typographical errors. Modifications made to: Constitution Article III and Article VI, Bylaws Article I Section 5, Article II Section 2 paragraph 5 and Section 3 paragraph 3, Article III Section 1 paragraph 5, and Article IV.

PREAMBLE

For the purpose of establishing and maintaining a place for the worship of Almighty God, our Heavenly Father; to provide for Christian fellowship for those of like precious faith, where the Holy Ghost may be honored according to our distinctive testimony; to assume our share of responsibility and the privilege of propagating the gospel of Jesus Christ by all available means, both at home and in foreign lands, we, whose names appear upon the assembly roster under above date, do hereby recognize ourselves as a local assembly in fellowship with and a part of the General Council of the Assemblies of God, and of the Michigan District of the Assemblies of God; and declare that we hereby adopt the following articles of church order and submit ourselves to be governed by them.

CONSTITUTION

ARTICLE I. NAME

The name of this church shall be TRI-CITY ASSEMBLY OF GOD of the City of Canton, State of Michigan.

ARTICLE II. PREROGATIVES

Section 1. Self Government.

This Assemblies of God church shall have the right to govern itself according to the standards of the New Testament Scriptures, "endeavoring to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace...till we will come in the unity of the faith, and of the knowledge of the Son of God, unto a perfect man, unto the measure of the stature of the fullness of Christ" (Ephesians 4:3,13).

Section 2. Real Estate.

In connection therewith, or incidental thereto, it shall have the right to purchase or acquire by gift, bequest, or otherwise, either directly or as trustee, and to own, hold in trust, use, sell convey, mortgage, lease, or otherwise dispose of any real estate or chattels as may be necessary for the furtherance of its purposes; all in accordance with its Constitution and Bylaws or as the same may be hereafter amended.

ARTICLE III. AFFILIATION AND RELATIONSHIP

This assembly declares itself to be voluntarily in full cooperative fellowship with all other churches affiliated with the Assemblies of God, Michigan District, with headquarters in Farmington Hills, Michigan, and The General Council of the Assemblies of God, with headquarters in Springfield, Missouri, and shares in the privileges and assumes the responsibilities enjoined by this affiliation.

As a member of the General Council this assembly agrees to:

1. Cooperate by every possible means in extension Of God's work and kingdom throughout the world.

2. Support the missionary program agreed upon by the District and General Councils.
3. Participate in District and General Council sessions via duly chosen delegates.
4. Invite the counsel of the district officary in the event of church difficulty and when changing pastors.
5. Share in support of the District and General Council (See '79 General Council Bylaws, Article XVIII, Section 1, paragraph c., and all of Section 2.).
6. Recognize that the District Council or the General Council of the Assemblies of God shall have the right and authority to:
 - (a) Approve scriptural doctrine and conduct;
 - (b) Disapprove unscriptural doctrine and conduct as stated in Article III, paragraph f., of the General Council Constitution, and
 - (c) Withdraw its certificate of membership if deemed necessary.

ARTICLE IV. TENETS OF FAITH

This assembly accepts the Holy Scriptures as the revealed will of God, the all sufficient rule of faith and practice, and for the purpose of maintaining general unity, adopts the Statement of Fundamental Truths of The General Council of the Assemblies of God.

STATEMENT OF FUNDAMENTAL TRUTHS:

The Bible is our all sufficient rule of faith and practice. Hence this statement of Fundamental Truths is intended as a basis of fellowship among us (i.e. that we all speak the same thing, 1 Corinthians 1:10; Acts 2:42). The human phraseology in such statement is not inspired nor contended for, but the truth set forth is held to be essential to a full Gospel ministry. No claim is made that it contains all truth in the Bible, only that it covers our present needs as to these fundamental matters.

1. The Scriptures Inspired:

The Scriptures, both the Old and New Testaments, are verbally inspired of God and are the revelation of God to man, the infallible, authoritative rule of faith and conduct (2 Timothy 3:15-17; 1 Thessalonians 2:13; 2 Peter 1:21).

2. The One True God:

The one true God has revealed Himself as the eternally self-existent "I AM" the Creator of heaven and earth and the Redeemer of mankind. He has further revealed himself as embodying the principles of relationship and association as Father, Son and Holy Ghost (Deuteronomy 6:4; Isaiah 43:10,11; Matthew 28:19; Luke 3:22).

3. The Deity of the Lord Jesus Christ:

The Lord Jesus Christ is the eternal Son of God. The Scriptures declare:

- (a) His virgin birth (Matthew 1:23; Luke 1:31,35).
- (b) His sinless life (Hebrews 7:26; 1 Peter 2:22).
- (c) His miracles (Acts 2:22; 10:38).
- (d) His substitutionary work on the cross (1 Corinthians 15:3; 2 Corinthians 5:21).
- (e) His bodily resurrection from the dead (Matthew 28:6; Luke 24:39; 1 Corinthians 15:4).
- (f) His exaltation to the right hand of God (Acts 1:9,11; 2:33; Philippians 2:9-11; Hebrews 1:3).

4. The Fall of Man:

Man was created good and upright; for God said, "Let us make man in our image, after our likeness." However, man by voluntary transgression fell and thereby incurred not only physical death, but also spiritual death, which is separation from God (Genesis 1:26,27; 2:17; 3:6; Romans 5:12-19).

5. The Salvation of Man:

Man's only hope of redemption is through the shed blood of Jesus Christ the Son of God.

- (a) Conditions to Salvation
Salvation is received through repentance toward God and faith toward the Lord Jesus Christ. By the washing of regeneration and renewing of the Holy Ghost, being justified by grace through faith, man becomes an heir of God according to the hope of eternal life (Luke 24:47; John 3:3; Romans 10:13-15; Ephesians 2:8; Titus 2:11; 3:5-7).

6. The Ordinances of the Church:

- (a) Baptism in Water
The ordinance of baptism by immersion is commanded in the Scriptures. All who repent and believe on Christ as Savior and Lord are to be baptized. Thus, they declare to the world that they have died with Christ and that they also have been raised with Him to walk in newness of life (Matthew 28:19; Mark 16:16; Acts 10:47,48; Romans 6:4).
- (b) Holy Communion
The Lord's Supper consisting of the elements - bread and the fruit of the vine - is the symbol expressing our sharing the divine nature of our Lord Jesus Christ (2 Peter 1:4); a Memorial of His suffering and death (1 Corinthians 11:26); and a prophecy of His second coming (1 Corinthians 11:26); and is enjoined on all believers "till He comes."

7. The Baptism in the Holy Ghost:

All believers are entitled to and should ardently expect and earnestly seek the promise of the Father, the baptism in the Holy Ghost and fire, according to the command of our Lord Jesus Christ. This was the normal experience of all in the early Christian Church. With it comes the endowment of power for life and service, the bestowment of the gifts and their uses in the work of the ministry (Luke 24:49; Acts 1:4-8; 1 Corinthians 12:1-31). This experience is distinct from and subsequent to the experience of the new birth (Acts 8:12-17; 10:44-46; 11:14-16; 15:7-9). With the baptism in the Holy Ghost come such experiences as an overflowing fullness of the Spirit (John 7:37-39; Acts 4:8), a deepened reverence for God (Acts 2:43; Hebrews 12:28), an intensified consecration to God and dedication to His work (Acts 2:42), and a more active love for Christ, for His Word and for the lost (Mark 16:20).

8. The Evidence of the Baptism in the Holy Ghost:

The Baptism of believers in the Holy Ghost is witnessed by the initial physical sign of speaking with other tongues as the Spirit of God gives them utterance (Acts 2:4). The speaking in tongues in this instance is the same in essence as the gift of tongues (1 Corinthians 12:4-10,28), but different in purpose and use.

9. Sanctification:

Sanctification is an act of separation from that which is evil, and of dedication unto God (Romans 12:1,2; 1 Thessalonians 5:23; Hebrews 13:12). The Scriptures teach a life of "holiness without which no man shall see the Lord" (Hebrews 12:14). By the power of the Holy Ghost we are able to obey the command: "Be ye holy, for I am holy" (1 Peter 1:15,16). Sanctification is realized in the believer by recognizing his identification with Christ in His death and resurrection, and by faith reckoning daily upon the fact of that union, and by offering every faculty continually to the dominion of the Holy Spirit (Romans 6:1-11,13; Romans 8:1,2,13; Galatians 2:20; Philippians 2:12,13; 1 Peter 1:5).

10. The Church and it's Mission:

The Church is the body of Christ, the habitation of God through the Spirit, with divine appointments for the fulfillment of His great commission. Each believer, born of the Spirit, is an integral part of the General Assembly and Church of the Firstborn, which are written in heaven (Ephesians 1:22,23; 2:22; Hebrews 12:23).

Since God's purpose concerning man is to seek and to save that which is lost, to be worshipped by man, and to build a body of believers in the image of His Son, the priority reason-for-being of the Assemblies of God as part of the Church is:

- (a) To be an agency of God for evangelizing the World (Acts 1:8; Matthew 28:19,20; Mark 16:15,16).
- (b) To be a corporate body in which man may worship God (1 Corinthians 12:13).
- (c) To be a channel of saints being perfected in the image of His Son (Ephesians 4:11-16; 1 Corinthians 12:28; 1 Corinthians 14:12).

The Assemblies of God exists expressly to give continuing emphasis to this reason-for-being in the New Testament Apostolic pattern by teaching and encouraging believers to be baptized in the Holy Spirit. This experience:

- (a) Enables them to evangelize in the power of the Spirit with accompanying supernatural signs (Mark 16:15-20; Acts 4:29-31; Hebrews 2:3,4).
- (b) Adds a necessary dimension to worshipful relationship with God (1 Corinthians 2:10-16; 1 Corinthians 12, 13, and 14).
- (c) Enables them to respond to the full working of the Holy Spirit in expression of fruit and gifts and ministries as in New Testament times for the edifying of the body of Christ (Galatians 5:22-36; 1 Corinthians 14:12; Ephesians 4:11,12; 1 Corinthians 12:28; Colossians 1:29).

11. The Ministry:

A divinely called and scripturally ordained ministry has been provided by our Lord for the threefold purpose of leading the Church in:

- (a) Evangelization of the world (Mark 16:15-20).
- (b) Worship of God (John 4:23,24).
- (c) Building a body of saints being perfected in the image of His Son (Ephesians 4:11-16).

12. Divine Healing:

Divine Healing is an integral part of the gospel. Deliverance from sickness is provided for in the atonement, and is the privilege of all believers (Isaiah 53:4,5; Matthew 8:16,17; James 5:14-16).

13. The Blessed Hope:

The resurrection of those who have fallen asleep in Christ and their translation together with those who are alive and remain unto the coming of the Lord is the imminent and blessed hope of the Church (1 Thessalonians 4:16,17; Romans 8:23; Titus 2:13; 1 Corinthians 15:51,52).

14. The Millennial Reign of Christ:

The second coming of Christ includes the rapture of the saints, which is our blessed hope, followed by the visible return of Christ with His saints to reign on earth for one thousand years (Zechariah 14:5; Matthew 24:27,30; Revelation 1:7; 19:11-14; 20:1-6). This millennial reign will bring the salvation of national Israel (Ezekiel 37:21,22; Zephaniah 3:19,20; Romans 11:26,27) and the establishment of universal peace (Isaiah 11:6-9; Psalms 72:3-8; Micah 4:3,4).

15. The Final Judgment:

There will be a final judgment in which the wicked dead will be raised and judged according to their works. Whosoever is not found written in the Book of Life, together with the devil and his angels, the beast and the false prophet, will be consigned to everlasting punishment in the lake which burneth with fire and brimstone, which is the second death (Matthew 25:46; Mark 9:43-48; Revelation 19:20; 20:11-15; 21:8).

16. The New Heavens and the New Earth:

"We, according to His promise, look for new heavens and a new earth, wherein dwelleth righteousness" (2 Peter 3:13; Revelation 21 and 22).

ARTICLE V. ORDINANCES

Section 1. Water Baptism.

The ordinance of Baptism by immersion in water (Matthew 28:19) shall be administered to all those who have repented of their sins and who have believed on the Lord Jesus Christ to the saving of their souls, and who give clear evidence of their salvation (Romans 6:3-5; Colossians 2:12).

Section 2. The Lord's Supper.

The ordinance of the Lord's Supper shall be observed regularly as enjoined in the Scriptures (Luke 22:19,20; 1 Corinthians 11:23-26).

ARTICLE VI. MEMBERSHIP

Section 1. Membership Eligibility.

Voting membership in this assembly shall be open to all those age 18 and older who give evidence of their faith in the Lord Jesus Christ, and who voluntarily subscribe to its tenets of faith and agree to be governed by its constitution and bylaws as herein set forth.

Section 2. Junior Membership

Membership shall be available for young people under 18 years of age who give evidence of the new birth, having received Christ as personal Savior, and who meet the usual qualifications for membership established by this assembly. They shall have voting privileges at 18 years of age.

Section 3. Inactive Membership.

Enrolled members who shall without good cause absent themselves from the services of the assembly for a period of 3 consecutive months or more, or who cease to contribute of their means to its support, or who may be out of harmony with its teachings, or who shall be under charges of misconduct, or who may have fallen under condemnation through sinful or worldly practices, shall be considered as inactive members and shall lose their voting privileges until they are restored to the fellowship, their standing to be settled by the definite action of the assembly through its elected officers.

ARTICLE VII. OFFICERS

Section 1. Officers.

There shall be a Pastor, a Board of Deacons, a Board of Administration, a Secretary, a Treasurer, and an Assistant Treasurer. Other officers shall be added as may be needed.

Section 2. Deacons and Trustees.

1. The Board of Deacons, consisting of not less than three members, shall function under the leadership of the Pastor. Of this Board of Deacons, one shall be the Secretary.
2. The Deacons shall be men of mature Christian experience and knowledge who shall be expected to meet the requirements as set forth in 1 Timothy 3 and Acts 6. They shall be free of marital entanglements. They shall be at least 25 years old, and shall have been members of the assembly for at least one year.
3. The Board of Administration shall consist of the Deacons and at least three Trustees. It shall function under the leadership of the Pastor and shall have the same secretary as the Board of Deacons.
4. The Trustees shall be men of mature Christian experience and knowledge. They shall be at least 25 years old and shall have been members of the assembly for at least one year.
5. No two members of the same immediate family may serve on the Board of Deacons or the Board of Administration at the same time
6. The administrative affairs of the church shall be carried on by these boards except in matters affecting the entire body. In such cases, they shall present their recommendations to the church for ratification.
7. The Treasurer and Assistant Treasurer shall serve the needs of both the Board of Deacons and the Board of Administration.

ARTICLE VIII. MEETINGS

Section 1. Public Worship.

Meetings for public worship shall be held on each Lord's Day and during the week as may be provided for under the direction of the Pastor and the Board of Deacons.

Section 2. Annual Business Meetings.

There shall be an annual business meeting of the assembly, at which time the election of officers shall take place and the report of all officers shall be presented. This meeting shall be held in January of each year. The time and place shall be announced by the Pastor. Due notice shall be given on the two Sundays immediately prior to the date of said meeting.

Section 3. Special Business Meetings.

Special business meetings of the assembly may be called when necessary, after proper notice has been given by the Pastor or by the Secretary of the assembly, provided the meeting has been agreed upon by a majority of the Board of Deacons or the Board of Administration. Special meetings may also be called by petition having been signed by not less than one-third of the active membership of the assembly, the petition to be placed in the hands of the Pastor or the Secretary and announcement made on the two Sundays immediately prior to the date of the meeting. However, before the right of petition is exercised, the church should request the help of the district officary.

Section 4. Quorum.

No record of any special or regular business meeting of the assembly shall be made unless one-third or more active members shall be present to constitute a quorum.

Section 5. Board of Administration Meetings.

The Board of Administration, with the Pastor, shall meet monthly for the transaction of routine business for the assembly. The time and place of these meetings is to be announced by the Pastor. Special meetings may be called by the Pastor or by the request of any two members of the Board of Administration.

Section 6. The Board of Deacons Meetings.

The Board of Deacons, with the Pastor, shall meet periodically to conduct business as their responsibilities dictate. These meetings may be combined with, or separate from, the meetings of the Board of Administration. If business pertaining to the unique responsibilities of the Board of Deacons is transacted at a Board of Administration meeting, only the Pastor and Deacons may exercise voting privileges. The times and places of Board of Deacons meetings will be announced by the Pastor. Meetings of this board may be called by the Pastor or by the request of any two Deacons.

ARTICLE IX. DEPARTMENTS AND COMMITTEES

Section 1. Sunday School.

There shall be a Sunday school created and conducted as a branch of the church activities.

Section 2. Youth Ministries.

There shall be a Youth Department formed under the supervision of the Pastor and Board of Deacons.

Section 3. Men's and Women's Ministries.

There may be Men's and Women's Departments which shall be formed and conducted under the supervision of the Pastor and Board of Deacons.

Section 4. Other Departments.

As need arises, other departments or committees may be established.

Section 5. Relationship.

All departments and committees shall be subordinate to the assembly and shall contribute to the harmony and development of the whole. They shall be under the general supervision of the Pastor and Board of Deacons, and the Pastor shall be an ex officio member of all committees or departments.

ARTICLE X. FINANCES

All funds for the maintenance of the assembly shall be provided by the tithes and offerings of the members and friends of the organization. Offerings shall be accepted by the assembly at such times and in such ways as agreed upon by the Pastor and Board of Deacons. These matters shall be administered by the Treasurer, or in his absence, by the Assistant Treasurer, under the direction of the Boards of Deacons and Administration (Malachi 3:10; Luke 6:38; 1 Corinthians 16:1-2; 2 Corinthians 9:6-8).

ARTICLE XI. PROPERTY

Section 1. Deed.

All property of the assembly shall be deeded to the assembly and held in its name. No property of the assembly shall be sold, leased, mortgaged, or otherwise disposed of without the same shall have first been recommended by a vote of at least two-thirds of the voting membership who are in attendance at a regular meeting or special meeting of the assembly which has been called for the consideration of the proposal. The Pastor and the Secretary of the assembly shall certify in such conveyance, lease, or mortgage, that the same has been duly authorized and recommended by a vote of the assembly. Such certificate shall be held to be conclusive evidence thereof.

Section 2. Defection.

In the event defection shall occur from the tenets of faith of this church as the same are stated in the Statement of Fundamental Truths in the Constitution of the General Council of the Assemblies of God, or from affiliation with the General Council of the Assemblies of God, any portion of the membership subscribing to and practicing the aforesaid tenets of faith and retaining membership with the Tri-City Assembly of God shall retain possession of, and title to, all properties of said church with full rights thereto as provided in its constitution and bylaws.

Section 3. Cessation.

In the event this church shall cease to function for the purpose as declared heretofore in its Articles of Agreement and/or the Articles of its Constitution, then after providing for the payment of its debts, the remaining assets will not inure to the benefit of any private person or persons but all such remaining assets shall revert to, and be transferred to, the parent body The General Council of the Assemblies of God, a Missouri Corporation with headquarters at Springfield, Missouri. The General Council of the Assemblies of God shall have full authority to sell such property and to use the proceeds derived therefrom for the extension of the work of the Assemblies of God within the Michigan District and under the direction of the presbytery of said district.

In the event of cessation of this church, its Board of Deacons shall within 1 year thereafter transfer all properties and any remaining assets to the General Council of the Assemblies of God in accordance with the foregoing provisions. If such transfer is not made within the time prescribed herein or if the aforesaid The General Council of the Assemblies of God shall be unable or unwilling to accept the aforesaid transfer as an organization operated exclusively for religious purposes with tax-exempt status under Section 501 (c) (3) of the Internal Revenue Code, then disposition thereof shall be made by the court of the county in which this church is located, provided that in such case proceeds of the dissolution shall be distributed to an organization or organizations having purposes nearest the purposes of the General Council of the Assemblies of God, and which are organized and operated exclusively for religious purposes, and which have established tax-exempt status under Section 501 (c) (3) of the Internal Revenue Code.

ARTICLE XII. AMENDMENTS

This Constitution may be amended by a two-thirds vote of the membership of the assembly in attendance at any regular or special meeting called for that purpose, provided due notice of such proposed change shall have been made at all the services on at least two consecutive Sundays immediately prior to the time of such meeting. It shall be understood that this does not apply to the article of Faith (ARTICLE IV), which stands regardless of majority.

BYLAWS

ARTICLE I. DUTIES OF OFFICERS

Section 1. Pastor.

The Pastor shall be considered as the spiritual overseer of the assembly and shall direct all of its activities. He shall be the president of the corporation and shall act as chairman of all the business meetings of the assembly and of the Boards of Deacons and Administration. He shall be an ex officio member of all committees and departments. He shall provide for all the services of the assembly and shall arrange for all special meetings, conventions, or revival campaigns. No person shall be invited to speak or preach in the assembly without his approval.

Section 2. Board of Deacons.

The Board of Deacons is chosen to serve the church and therefore shall act in an advisory capacity with the Pastor in all matters pertaining to the assembly in its spiritual life and the ministry of its ordinances. The Board of Deacons shall act in the examination of applicants for membership, and also in the administration of discipline.

The Board of Deacons, under the leadership of the Pastor, is responsible for authorizing the creation of paid church staff positions (pastoral staff, office staff, custodial staff, etc.), their associated compensation levels, and the budgets required to support these compensation levels. The Treasurer and Assistant Treasurer will, as directed, assist in the establishment of the required budgets and will execute the financial directives of this board.

A majority present at any meeting of the Board of Deacons shall constitute a quorum, provided all the members have been notified to be present. In the event the assembly is temporarily without a pastor or the Pastor is unable to be present, the Board of Deacons shall be empowered to provide for its own chairman from its membership in order to transact business for the assembly. This same individual will, if required, act as temporary chairman of the Board of Administration.

Section 3. Board of Administration.

The Deacons and Trustees shall jointly be the custodians of all the real property of the assembly. They shall meet as the Board of Administration for discharge of their duties as necessity may demand, subject to the call of the Pastor, who shall serve as their chairman.

The Board of Administration, under the leadership of the Pastor, is responsible for the maintenance of all lands, buildings, vehicles, equipment, and materials of the assembly. They are also responsible for authorizing the expenditures necessary to execute the procurement, maintenance, and disposal of the same. All financial budgets and authorizations, other than those associated with staff compensation, are the responsibility of this board. The Treasurer and Assistant Treasurer will, as directed, assist in the establishment of budgets and will execute the financial directives of this board.

A majority present at any meeting of the Board of Administration shall constitute a quorum, provided all the members have been notified to be present. In the event the assembly is temporarily without a pastor or the Pastor is unable to be present, the Board of Administration shall be chaired by the temporary chairman of the Board of Deacons.

Section 4. Secretary.

The Secretary shall be the custodian of all legal documents, including the minutes of the official meetings of the Boards of Deacons and Administration, the annual business meeting, and any special business meetings of the assembly. He shall keep a record of the membership of the assembly and perform all of the obligations and responsibilities of the office to the proper discharge of his duties. It shall be noted here that the actual recording of minutes of the official meetings of the Boards of Deacons and Administration and the annual or special business meetings, shall be the responsibility of any officer of the church, (Deacons, Trustees, Secretary, Treasurer, or Assistant Treasurer), as appointed by the Pastor.

Section 5. Treasurer.

The Treasurer shall be entrusted with all the finances of the assembly which may be committed to him. He shall be responsible for the depositing of all funds into a responsible bank in the name of the assembly, and shall disburse the same by check, as authorized by the Pastor and Boards of Deacons and Administration. The Treasurer shall keep an itemized account of the receipts and disbursements. He shall present an itemized report at the regular meetings of the Board of Administration and a summarized report to the assembly at its regular business meeting. His accounts shall be audited under the direction of the Pastor and Board of Administration.

Section 6. Assistant Treasurer.

The Assistant Treasurer shall be fully versed in all activities of the Treasurer. He shall assist the Treasurer as directed by the Treasurer and Boards of Deacons and Administration. In the absence of the Treasurer, his duties shall be performed by the Assistant Treasurer.

ARTICLE II. ELECTIONS AND VACANCIES

Section 1. Pastor.

The Pastor shall be elected to serve for an indefinite period of time. He shall be nominated by the Board of Deacons after consultation with the district officary regarding available candidates. No candidate for pastor shall be considered or elected who is a non-Assemblies of God Minister. Only one name shall be voted upon at a time. Election shall be by secret ballot at a special meeting called for that purpose. A two-thirds majority vote of all votes cast shall be required to constitute an election.

Section 2. Treasurer and Assistant Treasurer.

1. The Treasurer and Assistant Treasurer shall be chosen from the membership of the assembly and shall be nominated by the nominating committee. They shall be elected by majority vote at regular annual business meetings. Both terms of office shall be for two years from time of election. Their terms of office shall be staggered such that their elections take place in alternating years.
2. The Treasurer may not be reelected to more than three consecutive terms. An individual who has held the office for three consecutive terms becomes ineligible to serve as treasurer for a period of one year. Past tenure in the office of treasurer shall not affect his eligibility for the office of assistant treasurer.

3. The Assistant Treasurer may not be reelected to more than two consecutive terms. An individual who has held the office for two consecutive terms becomes ineligible to serve as assistant treasurer for a period of one year. Past tenure in the office of assistant treasurer shall not affect his eligibility for the office of treasurer.
4. A standing assistant treasurer is eligible to be nominated for the office of treasurer. If elected, the Pastor and Board of Deacons shall appoint a qualified individual to fill his unexpired term.

Section 3. Deacons and Trustees.

1. The Deacons shall be chosen from the membership of the assembly. They shall be nominated by the nominating committee and elected by a majority vote at the annual business meeting. Their terms of office shall be for 3 years from the time of election. At the expiration of his term, he is ineligible to serve as a Deacon or Trustee for a period of one year.
2. The Trustees shall be chosen from the membership of the assembly. They shall be nominated by the nominating committee and elected by majority vote at the annual business meeting. Their terms of office shall be for 3 years from time of election. At the expiration of his term, he is ineligible to serve as a Deacon or Trustee for a period of one year.

Section 4. Secretary.

The Secretary shall be appointed by the Pastor, with selection being made from among the Deacons. He shall serve as secretary of the Board of Deacons and the Board of Administration. His term of office shall be for one year.

Section 5. Vacancies.

1. The Pastor:

In the event a pastor has serious charges preferred against him or his ministry has ceased to be effective, and no provision has been made for the termination of his ministry, responsibility is vested in the Board of Deacons to ask for the resignation of the Pastor at any of its business meetings. If such resignation is refused, the pastorate shall not be considered vacant until the action of the Board of Deacons has been sustained by a majority vote of the membership present and voting at a meeting called for the purpose, such meeting to be presided over by a district officer. When a vacancy in the pastorate shall occur, a supply shall be arranged for by the Board of Deacons until a pastor shall be chosen as prescribed in Section 1. In the case of a pastor's removal from office a report of such action shall be made to the District Council Office.

2. Other Officers:

- (a) Any office may be declared vacant by an act of the majority of the membership of the Board of Deacons at any regular or special business meeting. In the event that an office is vacated, the unexpired term shall be filled by appointment by the Pastor and Board of Deacons.
- (b) Ground for such action shall be: (1) Unscriptural conduct; (2) Departure from the tenants of faith; (3) incompetency in office.

- (c) Any incumbent under charges shall have the opportunity for a hearing of his case before the assembly if he so requests.

Section 6. The Nominating Committee.

The nominating committee shall consist of the Pastor and four mature members, in good standing, appointed by the Pastor.

ARTICLE III. MEMBERSHIP

Section 1. Requirements.

Minimum requirements for membership shall be as follows:

1. Born Again. Candidates for membership in this church shall be expected to give a clear testimony of having been born of the Spirit of God (John 3:3; 5-7; 2 Corinthians 5:17).
2. Baptism in the Holy Spirit. Applicants shall have received the Holy Spirit or be earnestly seeking to be baptized in the Holy Spirit (Acts 2:2-4).
3. Baptized in Water. All applicants shall have followed the scriptural command to be baptized in water by immersion in the Name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Ghost (Matthew 28:10).
4. God's Word. They shall believe in the inspiration of the Holy Scripture as the Word of God and the final authority in all matters of faith and conduct.
5. Holiness. They shall separate themselves from the world by refraining from the reading, viewing, listening, and participation in any activity, material and/or media that would be contrary to Scripture as pertaining to holiness, righteousness, clean living, and the testimony of such to this world. They shall reflect the truth that each believer's body is the temple of the Holy Spirit. (Luke 21:34,35; Romans 8:5-8, 12:1-2, 14:17-18; 1 Corinthians 6:9-10, 6:18-20; 2 Corinthians 6:14-18; Galatians 5:18-20; Ephesians 5:11; 1 Timothy 2:8-10; 4:12; James 4:4; 1 John 2:15-17; Titus 2:12; Revelation 21:8).
6. Habits. They shall abstain from the use of tobacco, alcoholic beverages, and the misuse of drugs (1 Corinthians 6:10-20).
7. Christ's Return. They shall earnestly cherish the hope and expectancy of the premillennial coming of the Lord Jesus (1 Thessalonians 4:16,17).
8. They shall fully subscribe to the Tenets of Faith as set forth in the Rules of Order of this assembly.
9. They shall indicate a willingness to cooperate in the work of this assembly, to be governed by its Rules of Order, and to contribute regularly to its support as the Lord may prosper them.

Section 2. Reception of Members.

1. Persons desiring to become active members of the assembly shall make the fact known to the Pastor, who shall examine the applicant according to the standard for membership.
2. The Pastor shall present the names of those who apply for membership with his recommendation to the Board of Deacons who shall act upon said recommendation and render a final decision. All persons who shall have met the membership requirements and have been approved shall be received into the assembly publicly at any of the regular Sunday services and their names inscribed on the roster.

Section 3. Discipline.

1. Any member of the assembly who shall willfully absent himself from the regular services for a period of 3 consecutive months, or who is under charges, shall be temporarily suspended from active voting membership pending investigation and final decision in his case.
2. Unscriptural conduct or doctrinal departure from the tenants of faith held by this assembly shall be considered sufficient grounds, upon which any person may be disqualified as a member (Matthew 18:15-18; Romans 16:17,18; 1 Corinthians 5:11; Galatians 1:8,9; Titus 3:1-15).

Section 4. Voluntary Withdraw.

Members in good standing, who may wish to sever their relationship with the assembly, or who may desire to be transferred to some other congregation, may apply to the Secretary for a letter, which shall be granted on the approval of the Pastor and Board of Deacons, said letter to be signed by the Pastor and the Secretary of the assembly.

Section 5. Membership Roll Revision.

The Pastor and Board of Deacons shall be authorized to revise the membership roll of the assembly annually, and to remove from the list of active members all names of those who may have become deceased during the year, together with the names of those who may have withdrawn from the fellowship, or who may have fallen into sin and whose lives may have become inconsistent with the standards and teachings of the assembly. The following rules and instructions shall be observed as occasion may require (Matthew 18:15-17; Romans 16:17,18; 1 Corinthians 5:1-5; 2 Thessalonians 3:6-15).

If a name is removed for cause, the one whose name is removed shall be notified of the action of the Pastor and Board of Deacons through the Secretary. If appeal is made to the Board for reconsideration of their action and reinstatement is not granted, the dismissed member may appeal to the congregation. The action of the assembly, by a majority vote, shall be considered final.

ARTICLE IV. SUNDAY SCHOOL

The Pastor and the Sunday school leadership shall have the right to appoint all officers, teachers, and other workers of the Sunday school, and, in consultation with the workers of the school, determine all policies and programs of the school.

ARTICLE V. YOUTH DEPARTMENT

A Youth Department organization may be formed. It shall be under the general supervision of the Pastor and the Board of Deacons and shall be conducted as a branch of activities of the assembly.

ARTICLE VI. PROPERTY RIGHTS

Section 1. Holding.

All property, real or chattel, shall be taken, held, sold, transferred, or conveyed in the corporate name of the assembly, or if the assembly is not incorporated, by trustees and their successors in office.

Section 2. Transferring.

No real or chattel property of the assembly shall be sold, leased, mortgaged or otherwise alienated without the same shall have been authorized by at least a two-thirds majority vote of the membership.

Section 3. Certification.

The Pastor and the Secretary of the assembly shall certify in such conveyance, lease, or mortgage, that the same has been duly authorized by the vote of the membership. Such certificates shall be held to be conclusive evidence thereof.

ARTICLE VII. ORDER OF BUSINESS

The regular order of business for the annual meeting of the assembly shall be as follows:

1. Devotional.
2. Reading of previous minutes by secretary.
3. Report of treasurer.
4. Report of committees.
5. Unfinished business.
6. Election of officers.
7. New business.
8. Adjournment.

ARTICLE VIII. PARLIAMENTARY ORDER

In the conducting of its affairs, the church shall be governed by parliamentary procedure as set forth in the current edition of "Roberts" Rules of Order Newly Revised," in keeping with the spirit of Christian love and fellowship.

ARTICLE IX. AMENDMENTS

The bylaws may be amended at any regular or special business meeting of the assembly by a two-thirds vote of the membership present.